

Waterworks

For your body to work at its best, the substances that make up your blood have to be carefully controlled. Your kidneys play a key role in this. All through the day and night, they remove excess water, salts, and poisonous wastes from your blood to make urine. The cleaned blood is then returned to your body's blood supply.

INSIDE A KIDNEY

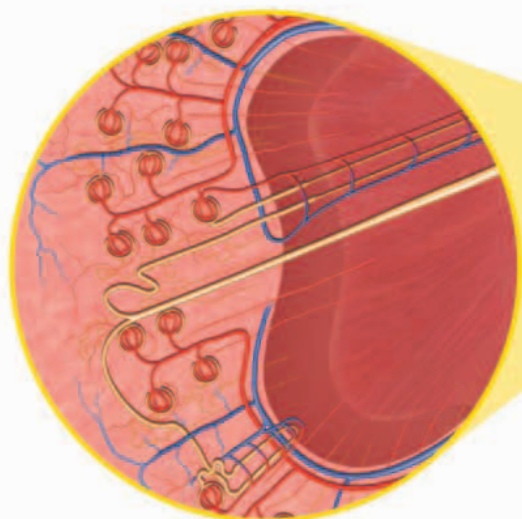
A network of blood vessels delivers blood to and from the cortex (outer part) and the medulla (inner part) of your bean-shaped kidneys. These areas are where urine is made. Urine then drains into the renal pelvis, a flattened, funnel-like tube, which empties it into the ureters for the next part of its journey out of the body.

The cortex is the outer part of the kidney.

The hollow renal pelvis collects urine.

The renal artery delivers the blood that has to be cleaned.

The renal vein removes the cleaned blood.



▲ BLOOD FILTERS

A microscopic view of the kidney reveals the tiny nephrons that loop between the kidney's cortex and medulla. They produce urine by filtering blood.

The ureter carries urine away from the kidney.

The medulla is the inner part of the kidney.

